The `pushDown` method handles the symmetric case: we need to move an element down towards the leaves of the heap, because it might be larger than (at least) one of its children.

There are two differences with the "bubble up" case:

- The triggering condition: in this case, the altered node doesn't violate invariant 3 with respect to its parent, but might violate it when compared to its children. This would happen, for instance, when the root is extracted from the heap and replaced with the last leaf in the array, or when a node priority is changed by assigning it a lower priority.
- The algorithm: for every level the element we are pushing down goes through, we need to find its highest-priority child, in order to find where the element could land without violating any property.

Listing 2.4 The pushDown method

```
function pushDown(pairs, index=0)
  currentIndex ← index
                                    #1
  while currentIndex < firstLeafIndex(pairs) do
                  #2
     (child, childIndex) ←
highestPriorityChild(currentIndex)                #3
    if child.priority > pairs[currentIndex].priority
then                       #4
      swap(pairs, currentIndex, childIndex)
         #5
      currentIndex ← childIndex
    else
                #6
      break
```